Phi Van Dat

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on developing novel methods in Machine Learning, with an emphasis on improving learning algorithms and optimization techniques. I have a primary interest in **Preference Learning** and **Optimization**, particularly in developing effective methods for learning from human preferences and designing optimization algorithms. I am eager to explore related research directions.

EDUCATION

Hanoi University of Science and Technology (HUST) — Hanoi, Vietnam
Bachelor of Computer Science (Undergraduate) *CPA: 3.62 / 4.0* — *Oct 2023 – Present*

HNUE High School for Gifted Students (HSGS) — Hanoi, Vietnam
Mathematics Honors Class — *Sep 2020 – Jun 2023*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

AI Resident — Sep 2026 – Present
Center for AI Research, VinUniversity — *Hanoi, Vietnam*

- Supervisor: **Prof. Dinh Ngoc Thanh**, VinUniversity
- Mentor: **Dr. Trung Le**, Monash University
- Research Topic: Optimization, Post-Training, Human-AI Alignment
- 1 preprint, with 4 submissions currently under review

Research Intern — Jul 2026 - Aug 2026
Computer Science Lab, University of Wyoming — *Wyoming, United States*

- Supervisor: **Dr. Duong Ngoc Nguyen**, University of Wyoming
- Research Topic: Distributed Machine Learning

Research Student — Aug 2025 – Present
Foundation Model Lab, BKAI, HUST — *Hanoi, Vietnam*

- Supervisor: **Dr. Ngo Van Linh**, Hanoi University of Science and Technology
- Research Topic: Knowledge Distillation
- 2 accepted publications at AAAI, EACL, with 1 submission currently under review

PUBLICATIONS

- **CTPD: Cross Tokenizer Preference Distillation**
  Truong Nguyen*, **Phi Van Dat***, Ngan Nguyen*, Linh Ngo Van, Trung Le, Thanh Hong Nguyen
  AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2026)

- **DWA-KD: Dual-Space Weighting and Time-Warped Alignment for Cross-Tokenizer Knowledge Distillation**
  Duc Trung Vu*, Pham Khanh Chi*, **Dat Phi Van***, Linh Ngo Van, Dinh Viet Sang, Trung Le
  European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL 2026)

PREPRINTS

- **Orthogonal Witness Control for Muon Optimization via Sigmoid Spectral Reshaping**
  Dat Phi Van*, Ngo Vu Minh*, Tuc Nguyen*, Thin Nguyen, Ngoc-Thanh Dinh, Trung Le
  Under review

UNDER REVIEW

- **GeoDPO: Geometric Token Importance for Stable LLM Alignment**
  First author, Meta Review Assessment: 3, commiting EACL 2027

- **Multi-Level On-Policy Preference Distillation for Small Language Models**
  First author, Under review AAAI 2027

- **Nested Risk-Aware Preference Distillation via Teacher Value Shaping**
  First author, Under review ACL 2027

- **Beyond Likelihood: A Preference Learning Perspective on Supervised Fine-Tuning**
  First author, Under review ACL 2027

- **A Survey on Human-AI Alignment: Taxonomy, Methods, and Challenges**
  Co-first author, Under review ACL 2027

AWARDS

Gold Medal — Hanoi Open Mathematics Competition (HOMC) 2018

Second Prize — Hanoi Mathematical Contest for Excellent Students 2019

Third Prize — HNUE Mathematical Contest for Excellent Students 2020, 2021

LANGUAGES

Vietnamese: Native

English: Full professional proficiency, IELTS 7.0

REFERENCES

Dr. Trung Le
Associate Professor, Monash University

Prof. Dinh Ngoc Thanh
Associate Professor, VinUniversity

Prof. Thanh Hong Nguyen
Associate Professor, University of Oregon

Prof. Thien Huu Nguyen
Associate Professor, University of Oregon

Dr. Ngo Van Linh
Associate Professor, Hanoi University of Science and Technology